Non-verbal communication and code-mixing in online spaces

Week 6

HS2911 Social Media and Mental Health



Agenda

1. Electronic Non-Verbal Cues (eNVCs)

2. Cultural Dimensions of eNVC

3. Social sharing of emotions (SSE)

4. Code-Mixing in online spaces



Electronic Non-Verbal Cues (eNVCs)

What are electronic nonverbal cues (eNVCs)?

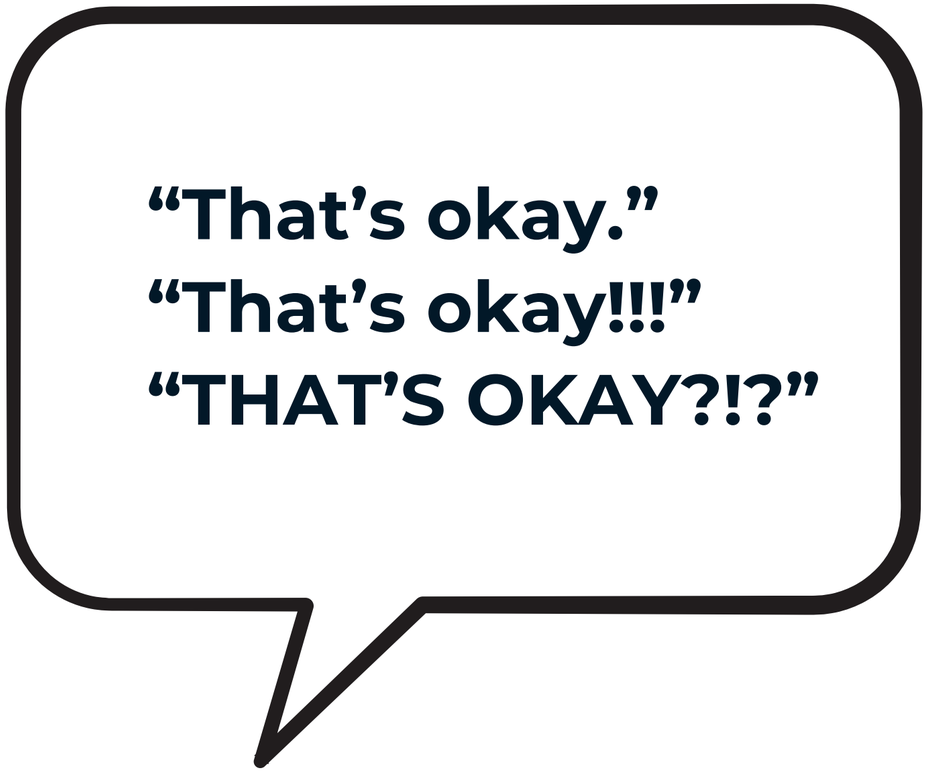
- Electronic nonverbal cues are the visual and audio cues that are present in online communication, such as emoticons, emojis, punctuation, character repetitions, and capitalisation

- These cues are used to convey emotions and tone, and can greatly impact the message being communicated

Social Functions

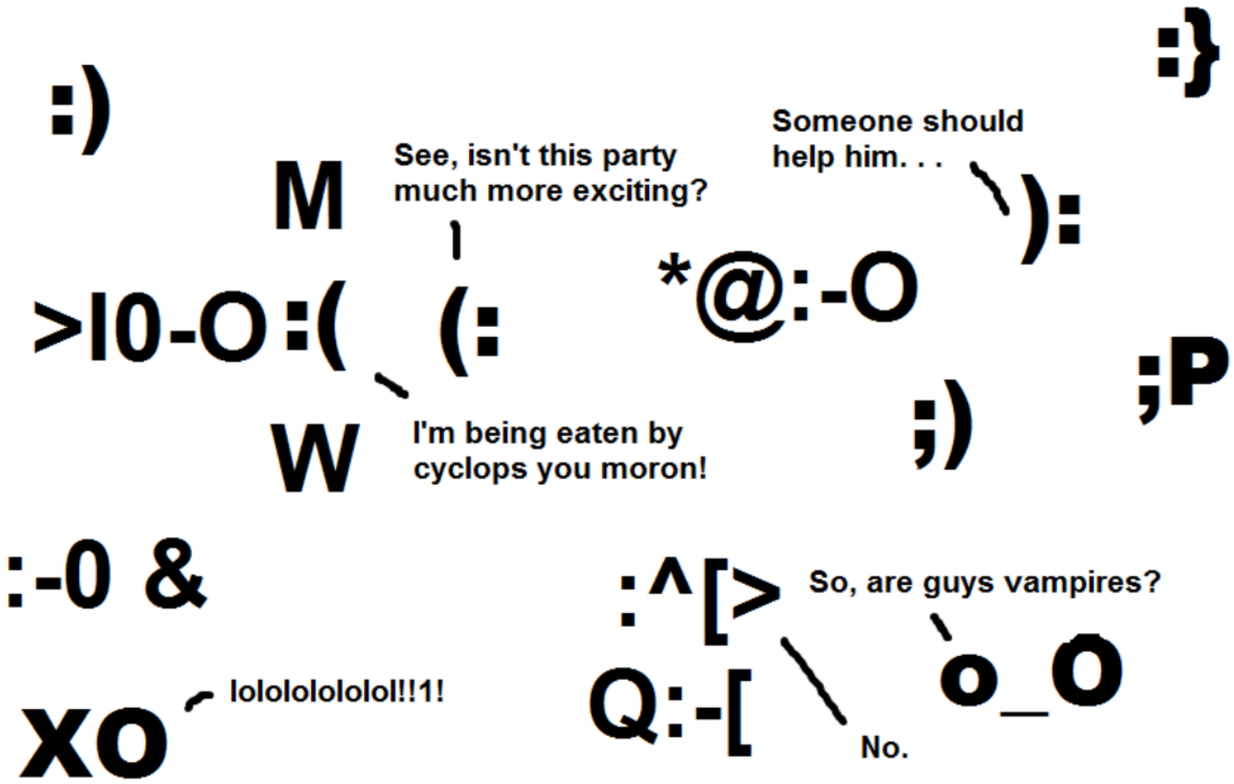
- ***Message disambiguation:*** Help receivers interpret nuances of meaning, attitudes of the conversational partner, and levels of emotion not captured by verbal elements alone (Gajadhar & Green, 2005; Riordan & Kruez, 2010)

- ***Increase message intensity:*** Make the message seem emotionally stronger (Derks et al., 2008)



Emoticons

- Graphic representations of facial expressions conveying the writer's emotional state (Walther & D'Addario, 2001)



Tom McCormack, 2013

Other types of eNVCS

- **Auditory cues**

  Indicate how the words should be spoken, conveying sound characteristics

a. Voice qualities: Strengthen the intonation (pitch), pronunciation, stress(emphasis) and tempo (rhythm)	**b. Vocalizations: Utterances, fillers, terms, that result in audible noise of non-verbal expressions**
‘I REALLY want that!!’ ‘it’s m-i-n-e’ ‘Best.Joke.Ever’ ‘WHAT?@#@#’	‘uhm’ ‘hmmmm’ ‘ugh’

Other types of eNVCS

- **Kinesics**
  (Body Movements & Gestures)

Involve any type of body movements, gestures, and posture

Hand gestures: ✋, 👏, ☜

Facial expressions: 😉 (wink), 😆 (laugh), XD, (͡° ͜ʖ ͡°)

- **Tactile Cues**
  (Simulated Touch)

Involve touch or physical interaction with another

Affect displays: kiss, HUGS, *high-five*, 🫂, 🤝

Pop-Quiz!

Can you decode these eNVCs?

What emotions are being expressed here?

I can't wait to see you! 😃

Pop-Quiz!

Can you decode these eNVCs?

What emotions are being expressed here?

Wow, that’s such a great idea... 🙄

Pop-Quiz!

Can you decode these eNVCs?

What emotions are being expressed here?

When the guy you like starts talking to another girl..👌

Pop-Quiz!

Can you decode these eNVCs?

What emotions are being expressed here?

ssooooo i see a coffee machine here. doES THIS MEAN WE NOW HAVE COFFEE AT SKECHERS??? oh myggod

Pop-Quiz!

Can you decode these eNVCs?

What emotions are being expressed here?

Wow, that’s such a great idea... 🙄

Nonverbal language employed can easily override the meaning of a verbal message, particularly when there is conflict between the two (Burgoon, 1985; Burgoon, Buller, & Woodall, 1996)

Cultural Dimensions of eNVC

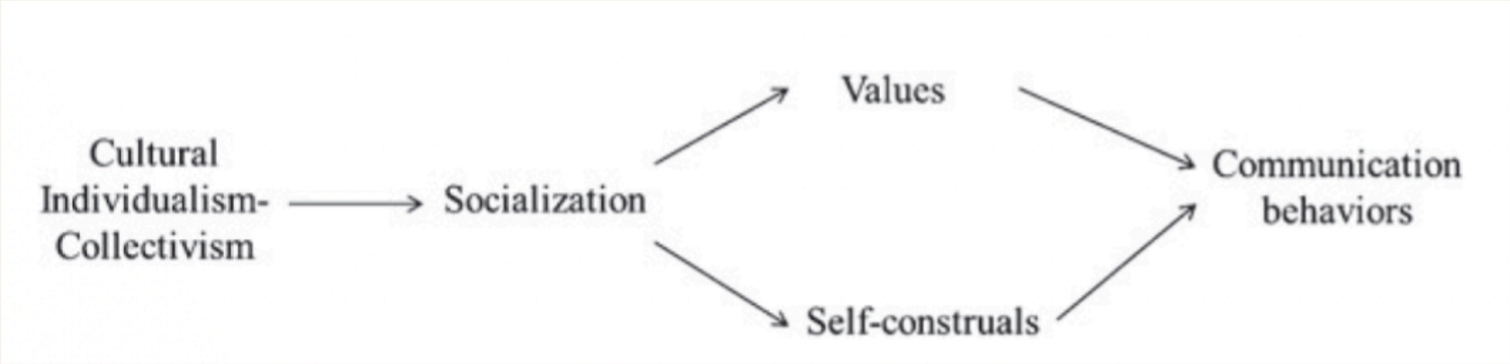
Cross-Cultural Comparison of Nonverbal Cues in Emoticons on Twitter: Evidence from Big Data Analysis Jaram Park, Young Min Baek, & Meeyoung Cha‘

Cultural Dimensions of eNVC

Culture shapes verbal and nonverbal communication

- “People learn how to communicate their thoughts, feelings, and values from their shared culture” (Gudykunst & Lee, 2005)
- “The styles individuals use to communicate vary across cultures” (Gudykunst et al., 1996)

Gudykunst’s cultural variability in communication framework (1996)



Cross-cultural differences in eNVC usage

Main Findings: Differences in emotion detection and expression across cultures

Individualistic cultures vs. Collectivist cultures

- Favor horizontal & mouth-oriented emoticons like :) and :-(
- Highlight the *self*
- Expected to clearly express one's own views or feelings with explicit signs or cues (Nisbett & Masada, 2003)

- Favor vertical and eye-oriented emoticons like ^_^ and T_T
- Highlight *shared values* in a society
- Communication behaviors are less assertive and indirect, relying on implicit signs or cues (Nisbett & Masada, 2003)

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Social sharing of emotions (SSE)

Expressing emotions in blogs: The role of textual paralinguistic cues in online venting and social sharing posts Carmina Rodríguez-Hidalgo, Ed S.H. Tan, Peeter W.J. Verlegh

Social sharing of emotions (SSE)

What is SSE?

- *When a person experiences an episode that affects their emotional balance, the resulting emotions are quickly expressed to recipients close to that person, triggering a process known as the social sharing of emotions (SSE) (Luminet, Bouts, Delie, Manstead & Rime, 2000)*

- Intrinsic interpersonal communicative act between

  A. The person who experiences an emotion, feeling an urge to affiliate and express it

  B. The recipient of the shared emotion



Social sharing of emotions (SSE)

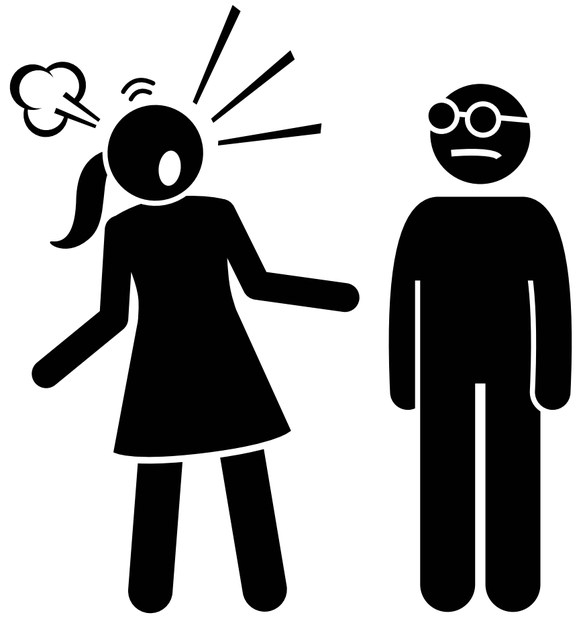
Emotional Venting

- Emotional “outburst” meant to “take the feelings off one’s chest” (Nills & Rime, 2012)

- May have negative implications:

    - Exacerbates the negative emotion because it increases the focus towards the negative and hinders coming to terms with the negative experience (Carver, Scheier & Weintraub, 1989)

    - Venting diminishes the possibilities of receiving constructive feedback, due to the disregard for the listener (Nils & Rime, 2012)



Three phases of online SSE

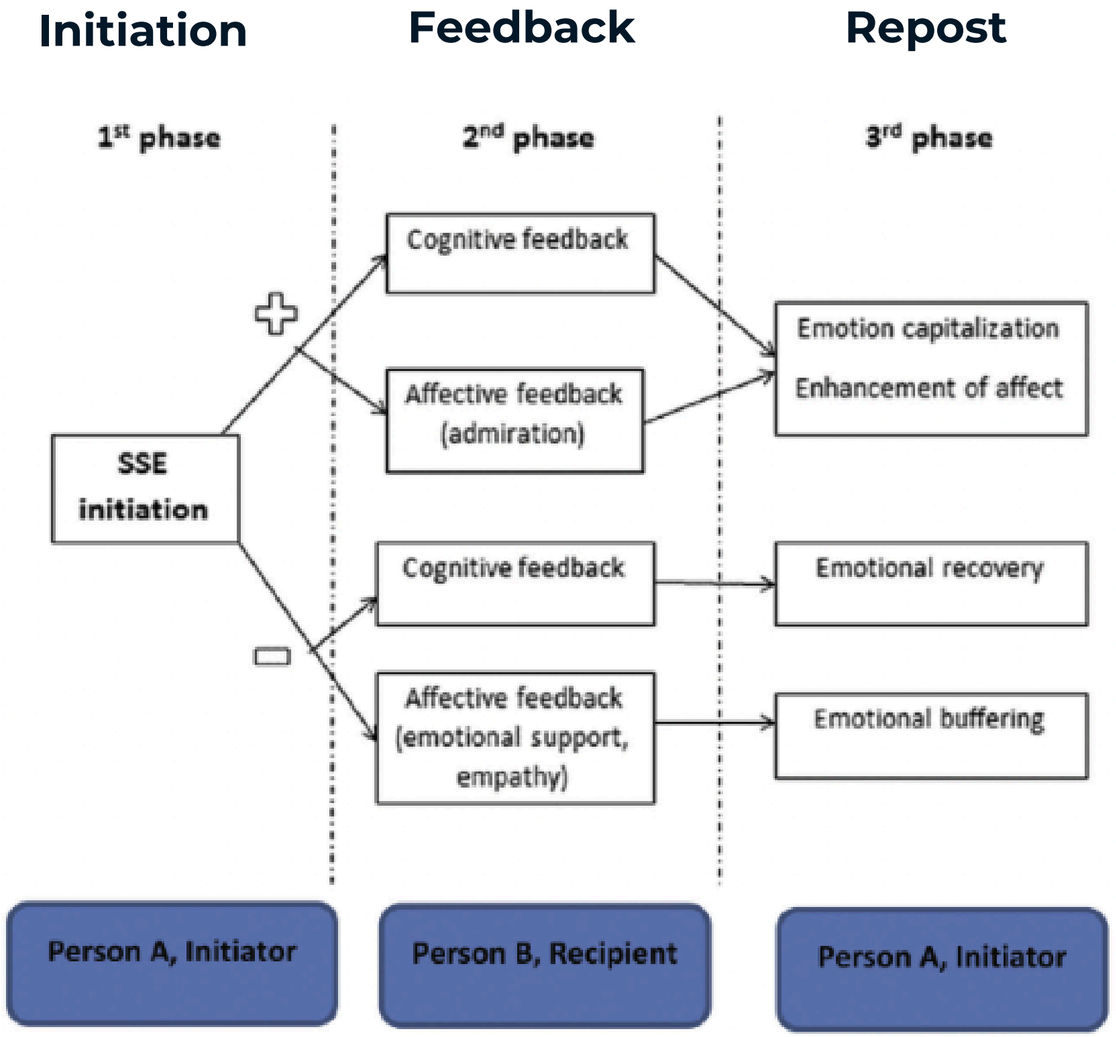


Fig. 1. The three-phased cycle of online social sharing.

Theoretical Frameworks

Social Information Processing Theory (Walther, 1992)

- CMC lacks the nonverbal language proper of FtF communication.
- Individuals, motivated by a deep desire to form interpersonal relationships and affinity with others, adapt their communicative behaviours using the cues available in the CMC medium to fulfil these relational goals

Emotional Mimicry in Context (Hess & Fischer, 2013)

- Occurs when others' posture, gestures and facial expressions are mimicked
- Mimicry is highly dependent on the social context, particularly on the type of emotional signal being mimicked and the relationship between the initiator and the observer

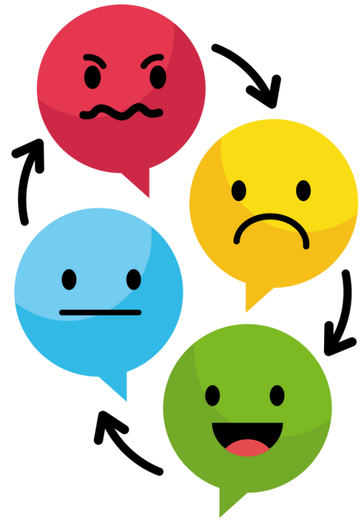
TPC in Social Sharing of Emotion

Textual paralanguage cues (TPC)

- Focuses only on *text* and how it is styled to convey tone or emotion
- Text-specific modifications like punctuation, capitalisation, and repetition

Main Findings

- TPC prevailed in SSE blogposts and strongly dominated in emotional venting posts
- TPC were more common in affective feedback than cognitive feedback
- Mimicry: The presence of tactile affective cues (hugs & kisses) in the initiation phase predicted their presence in the affective feedback



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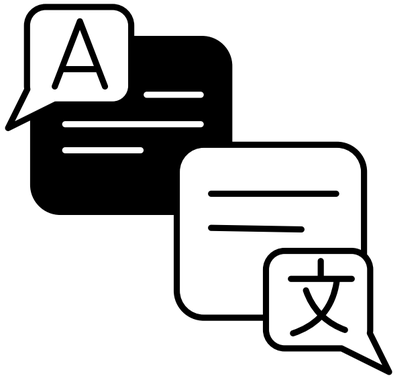
Code-Mixing in online spaces

Malay-English Code-Mixing Insertion: Why ‘Lepaking’ In Preference to ‘Hanging Out’?
AZU FARHANA, A. , SHAMALA, P., MD JAIS, I.

Code-mixing

- Bhatia and Ritchie (2004) define code-mixing as:

  “Code-mixing refers to the mixing of various linguistic units (words, phrases, clauses, and sentences) primarily from two participating grammatical systems across sentence boundaries within a speech event.”



- 3 types of code-mixing (Musyken, 2000)

  (1) **Insertion:** occurs when lexical items from one language are incorporated into another

  (2) ***Alternation:*** *occurs when structures of two languages are alternated indistinctively both at the grammatical and lexical level*

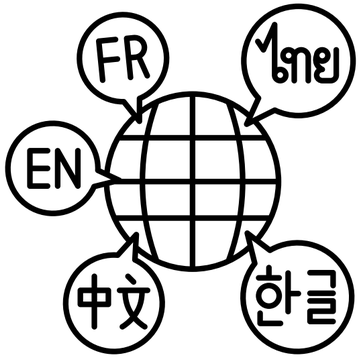
  (3) ***Congruent lexicalization:*** *refers to the situation where two languages share grammatical structures which can be filled lexically with elements from either language*

More examples

Type	Example	Translation	Explanation
Insertion	Let's go ***lepaking*** this weekend.	Let's go ***hang out*** this weekend.	Single word or phrase insertion The **grammar of the dominant language** (English) governs the sentence
Alternation	***Je suis fatigué,*** but I still have work to do.	***I am tired,*** but I still have work to do.	Occurs at the phrase or clause level Each language retains its **own grammar rules**
Congruent Lexicalization	She was so ***kancheong*** during the exam.	She was so ***nervous*** during the exam.	Occurs when two languages **share similar grammatical structures**, speakers freely insert words from either language into a single structure

Theoretical Framework

Socio-realistic theory (Kachru, 1974)



- Language develops through a period of time and it functions according to the time it is currently in
- Language adapts and evolves to meet the needs of its **social, cultural, and temporal context**
- Linguistic forms change based on interaction between **speakers, functions, and forms**
- **Localisation:** Borrowing and blending languages to create contextually relevant varieties

Reasons for code-mixing

Main Findings

The upward trend of '***Englishization'*** *in digital spaces:*

Code-mixing insertion practice of English morpheme (-ing) into Malay lexical item (lepak) by Malaysians on Facebook

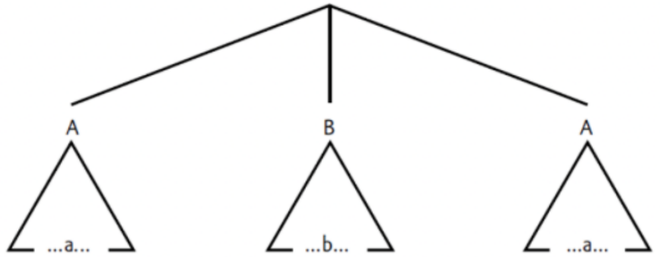
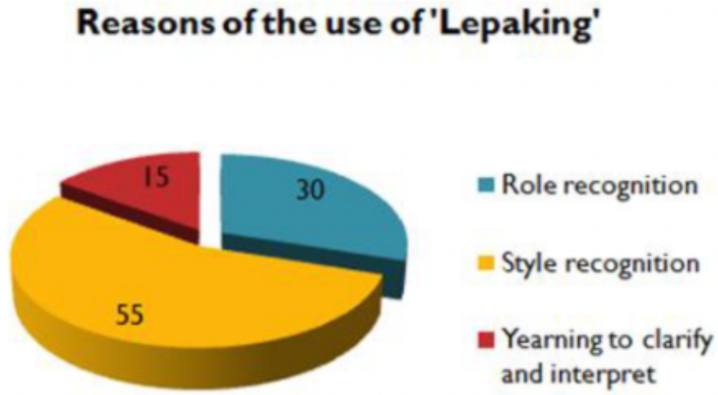


Figure 1*. A graphic demonstration of insertion.*
Source: Muysken (2000)

Reasons for code-mixing online include:

A. **Role identification:** social, registral, educational
B. **Style identification:** the language trend
C. **The yearning to clarify and interpret:** the speaker's attitude and relationship with other persons and vice versa



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